Process Mapping and Optimisation Framework

Data Analytics, Reporting Governance and Continuous Improvement

Maximus UK

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Role context: Senior People Data Analyst / Reporting & Data Visualisation Manager
Version: 1.0 | Status: Working framework

Purpose: to document the end-to-end process mapping, data quality, reporting governance and optimisation approach used to standardise analytics delivery, reduce manual effort and improve confidence in operational and people analytics reporting.

Internal working document - no employee-level personal data included

Document control

Document title	Process Mapping and Optimisation Framework - Data Analytics
Organisation context	Maximus UK
Document owner	Teruyuki Ito
Primary audience	Analytics, HR, Operations, Finance-adjacent stakeholders, service leads and reporting consumers
Scope	People analytics, operational reporting, KPI governance, Power BI reporting lifecycle, data quality controls and continuous improvement routines
Version	1.0
Status	Working framework
Confidentiality note	This document excludes confidential employee-level data and uses aggregated/process-level examples only.

Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of update	Status
0.1	Initial discovery	Yuki	Mapped current reporting and analytics process, key pain points and stakeholder handoffs.	Draft
0.8	Optimisation design	Yuki	Added target-state process, KPI governance, RACI, control checkpoints and implementation roadmap.	Review
1.0	Working framework	Yuki	Finalised process maps, delivery model, benefits measures and continuous improvement backlog.	Working baseline

Contents

1. Executive summary

This document sets out a structured process mapping and optimisation framework for analytics delivery within Maximus UK. The framework was designed around the practical issues typically seen in reporting environments: inconsistent KPI definitions, manual extracts, repeated data cleansing, limited process ownership, late-stage validation and reporting rework. The intention was to create a repeatable operating model where business requirements, data definitions, quality checks, reporting outputs and governance routines are clear from the start.

The scope covers the end-to-end route from stakeholder request to published dashboard or management report. It combines process mapping, Lean-style waste analysis, KPI governance, data quality controls, Power BI lifecycle management, RACI ownership, RAID tracking and adoption planning. The framework is written to be reusable across people analytics, workforce reporting, operational performance reporting, finance-adjacent management information and transformation dashboards.

Area	Current-state issue	Optimised control
Requirement intake	Requests arrive through different channels with uneven detail.	Single analytics intake template, triage criteria and priority scoring.
KPI definitions	Same metric interpreted differently across teams or reports.	Approved KPI dictionary with named business owner and calculation logic.
Data preparation	Manual joins, one-off Excel cleansing and duplicated transformation logic.	Reusable semantic model, standard dimensions and documented business rules.
Validation	Quality checks happen late, often after report build.	Control checks at extract, model and report layers with exception logging.
Adoption	Users rely on analyst-created packs rather than self-service.	Certified Power BI reports, training, office hours and usage monitoring.

Framework outcomes

- A consistent process map for analytics reporting from request intake to benefits review.
- A target-state operating model that separates requirement ownership, data ownership, report ownership and decision ownership.
- A prioritised optimisation backlog linked to measurable benefits such as cycle time, rework reduction, data quality improvement and adoption.
- A governance rhythm that keeps reporting aligned to business priorities without creating unnecessary administration.
- A reusable documentation pack that supports auditability, handover, training and continuous improvement.

2. Background and scope

The analytics environment involved multiple stakeholder groups consuming workforce, operational and performance information for decision making. Reporting demand was growing, but parts of the delivery process still depended on manual extraction, local spreadsheets and informal knowledge held by individual analysts or business users. The process mapping work was therefore focused on making the analytics lifecycle visible, standardised and easier to control.

2.1 Business context

Dimension	Description
Business areas supported	People analytics, HR operations, service operations, finance-adjacent reporting and management information.
Typical stakeholders	HR leadership, operational leads, finance partners, service managers, transformation leads and senior reporting consumers.
Reporting tools	Power BI, Excel, SQL-based extracts, Power Query, SharePoint or Teams-based distribution, and governance documentation.

Data themes	Workforce movements, attendance, capacity, performance, case management, service outcomes, finance-adjacent trend reporting and data quality measures.
Pain point pattern	High demand for analytics but inconsistent process discipline across intake, definition, build, validation and adoption.
Optimisation principle	Move from person-dependent reporting to process-led, governed and reusable analytics delivery.

2.2 In scope and out of scope

Area	In scope	Out of scope / boundary
Process mapping	As-is and to-be process maps for analytics requests, dashboard delivery and reporting governance.	Formal redesign of upstream HR or finance operating processes outside analytics control.
Data quality	Completeness, duplication, validity, timeliness, reconciliation and exception logging.	Technical remediation inside source systems unless assigned through IT change process.
Reporting lifecycle	Power BI dataset, dashboard, UAT, publishing, access, training and monitoring.	Replacement of enterprise systems or HRIS platform selection.
KPI governance	Definitions, ownership, calculation logic, refresh cadence and certification status.	Creation of business strategy or policy outside reporting governance.
Benefits tracking	Cycle time, rework, adoption, defect reduction and stakeholder confidence measures.	Financial audit or payroll sign-off authority.
Change adoption	Training, documentation, office hours and handover.	Line-management performance management of reporting consumers.

3. Process mapping method

The method combined business analysis techniques with practical analytics delivery controls. The aim was not to produce a theoretical process map, but to show where the work actually happened, where decisions were delayed, where data quality issues entered the process and where ownership was unclear.

3.1 Method stages

Stage	Activity	Output	Decision gate
1. Discover	Interview report requestors, analysts, data owners and leadership users.	Stakeholder map, report inventory and process notes.	Scope confirmed.
2. Map current state	Document every handoff from request to published output.	Swimlane process map and pain point log.	As-is process signed off.
3. Analyse waste	Classify delays, rework, duplication, over-processing and unclear ownership.	Waste analysis and root cause summary.	Priority issues agreed.
4. Define controls	Standardise intake, KPI definitions, data checks, UAT and publishing rules.	Control framework and RACI.	Control owners confirmed.
5. Design target state	Create a to-be process with reusable model and clear governance.	Target process map and operating model.	Build approach approved.
6. Implement	Run dashboard/data model changes in short sprints with UAT.	Certified reports, documentation and backlog.	Go-live decision.
7. Improve	Review adoption, defects, backlog and benefits monthly.	Continuous improvement log.	Benefits review completed.

3.2 Process mapping standards used

- Swimlane mapping to show business, analytics, data and leadership handoffs.

- SIPOC to clarify suppliers, inputs, process steps, outputs and customers.
- RACI to make ownership explicit for requirements, data, dashboards and decisions.
- Lean waste analysis to identify manual work, waiting time, duplication and rework.
- Control point mapping to show where validation should happen before output publication.
- Backlog scoring to prioritise fixes based on impact, effort, risk and stakeholder dependency.

4. Current-state process map

The current-state mapping exercise showed that the reporting process was functional but too dependent on informal routes, manual data preparation and late validation. The biggest issue was not the dashboard tool itself; it was the lack of a consistently governed route from business question to trusted metric.

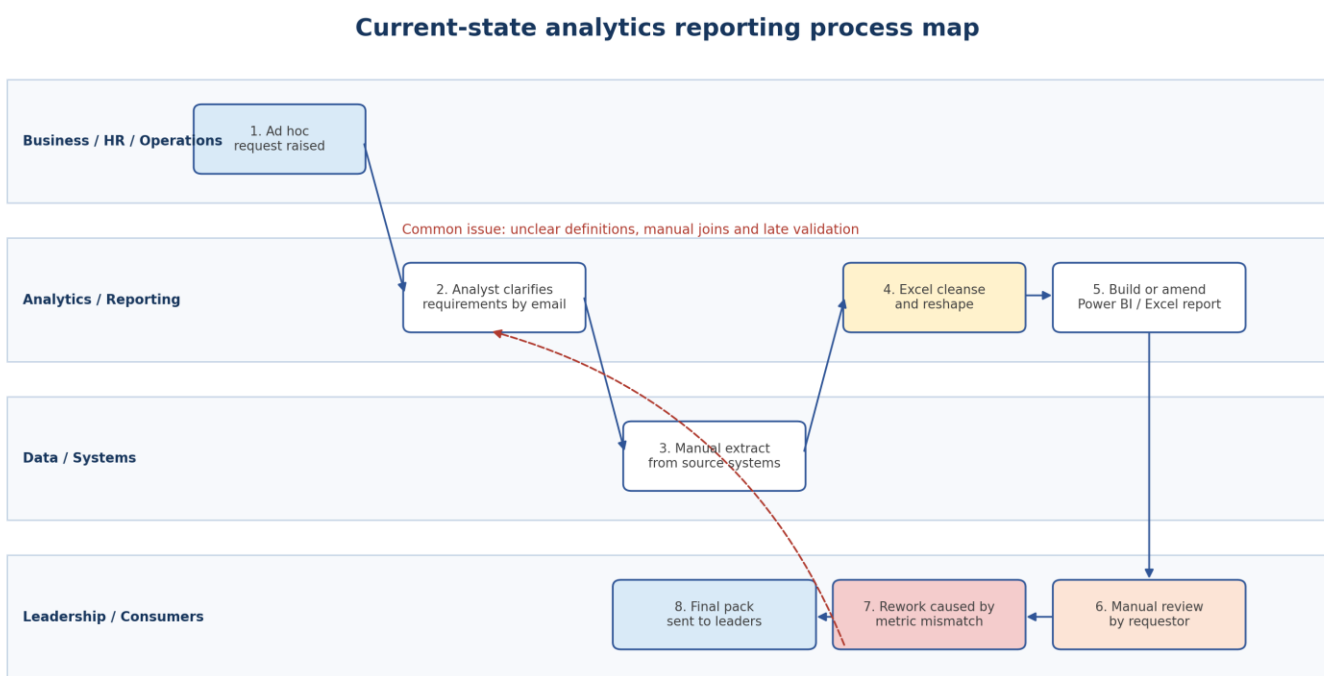

Figure 1. Current-state analytics reporting process map.

4.1 Current-state step analysis

Step	Process activity	Owner	Key issue observed	Optimisation opportunity
1	Request raised through email, Teams or meeting action.	Business user	Request detail varies and priority is unclear.	Create standard intake form and triage criteria.
2	Analyst clarifies requirement through follow-up messages.	Analytics	Repeated clarification creates delay and context loss.	Use structured requirement questions and acceptance criteria.
3	Data extract prepared from source systems or local files.	Analytics / Data	Manual extraction logic may differ by report.	Document source-to-target mapping and automate repeat extracts.
4	Data cleansed, joined and reshaped in Excel or Power Query.	Analytics	Business rules sit inside local files and are hard to reuse.	Move repeat logic into governed dataset or semantic model.
5	Report or dashboard created or amended.	Analytics	Report design can start before KPI definition is agreed.	Require KPI definition and data owner sign-off before build.

6	Business review happens close to final delivery.	Requestor	Late-stage disputes on definitions or population filters.	Introduce UAT checklist and early prototype review.
7	Rework cycle to fix metric mismatch or data issues.	Analytics / Requestor	Rework consumes delivery capacity and reduces confidence.	Use exception log and root cause review to prevent repeat defects.
8	Output distributed to leadership or wider users.	Analytics	Distribution can happen without adoption, usage or retirement plan.	Certify reports, monitor usage and retire duplicate outputs.

5. Pain points, waste and root causes

The waste analysis was used to move the discussion away from symptoms and towards fixable process causes. This was especially useful because dashboard delays were often caused by upstream ambiguity rather than by the visual build activity itself.

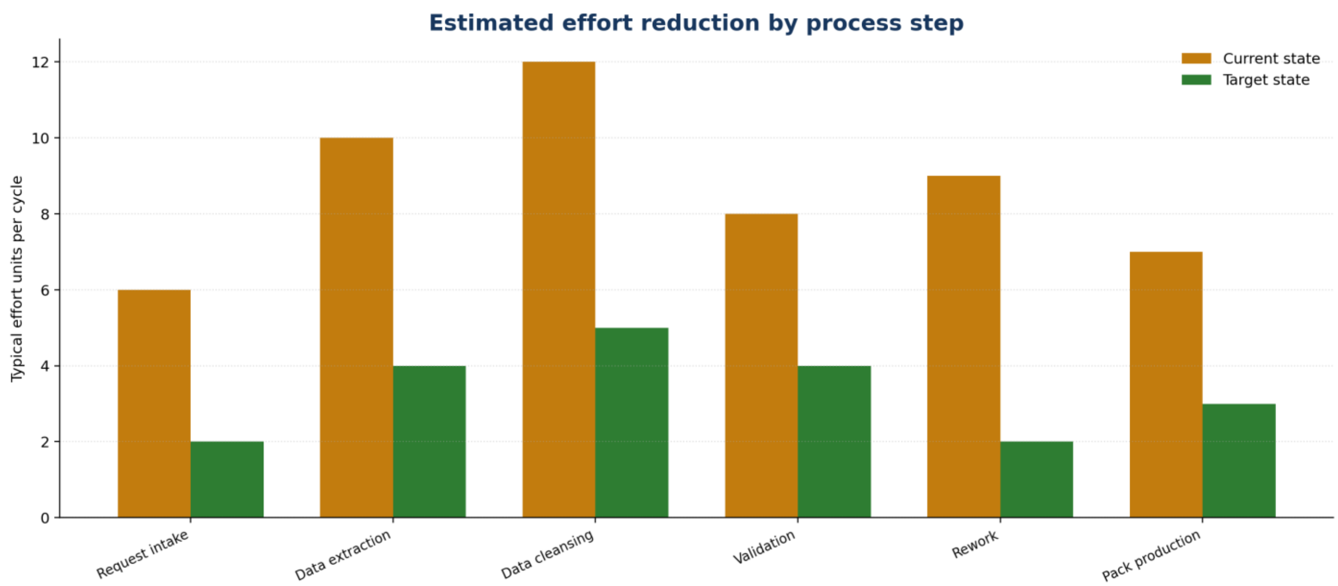

Figure 2. Estimated reduction in effort once intake, definitions, data quality and build controls are standardised.

5.1 Pain point register

ID	Pain point	Root cause	Impact	Severity	Proposed fix
P1	Different teams use different definitions for the same metric.	No single approved KPI dictionary or metric owner.	Conflicting figures in leadership packs.	High	Create KPI dictionary with owner, logic, filters, refresh and sign-off.
P2	Analysts repeat similar data preparation for multiple reports.	Transformation logic stored in local files.	Manual effort and inconsistent outputs.	High	Build reusable datasets, standard dimensions and certified Power BI models.
P3	Data quality issues are found during report review.	Validation checks not embedded at extract and model stages.	Rework, late delivery and stakeholder frustration.	High	Add control checks, exception log and defect root cause review.
P4	Reporting requests arrive without priority or clear business value.	No intake triage process.	Low-value requests compete with critical business reporting.	Medium	Introduce request scoring based on value, risk, urgency and regulatory sensitivity.

P5	Senior users ask for manual packs instead of using dashboards.	Limited confidence, training gaps or poor discoverability.	Self-service adoption remains low.	Medium	Publish certified reports, run training and provide report catalogue.
P6	Data ownership is unclear when anomalies appear.	No RACI for data source, business rule and report ownership.	Issues are bounced between teams.	High	Use RACI and escalation route for each critical dataset and KPI.
P7	Old reports continue after replacement reports are available.	No reporting lifecycle or retirement control.	Duplicate reporting and inconsistent data usage.	Medium	Maintain report inventory with certification, usage and retirement status.
P8	Dashboard changes are not always documented.	Change control is informal.	Loss of auditability and handover risk.	Medium	Create change log, version notes and UAT evidence for certified reports.

5.2 Root cause themes

- Governance gap: reporting controls existed in practice but were not consistently documented or owned.
- Definition gap: metric logic was sometimes understood by individual analysts rather than captured in a shared dictionary.
- Process gap: request intake, prioritisation, UAT and publishing did not always follow one repeatable route.
- Data quality gap: checks were more reactive than preventive, causing issues to surface late.
- Adoption gap: dashboards needed stronger user enablement, clearer ownership and better retirement of duplicate outputs.

6. Target-state operating model

The target-state model moves analytics delivery from a reactive reporting service to a managed analytics product model. It keeps the process simple but introduces the control points needed for trusted reporting: intake, triage, KPI approval, data modelling, validation, UAT, publication and benefits review.

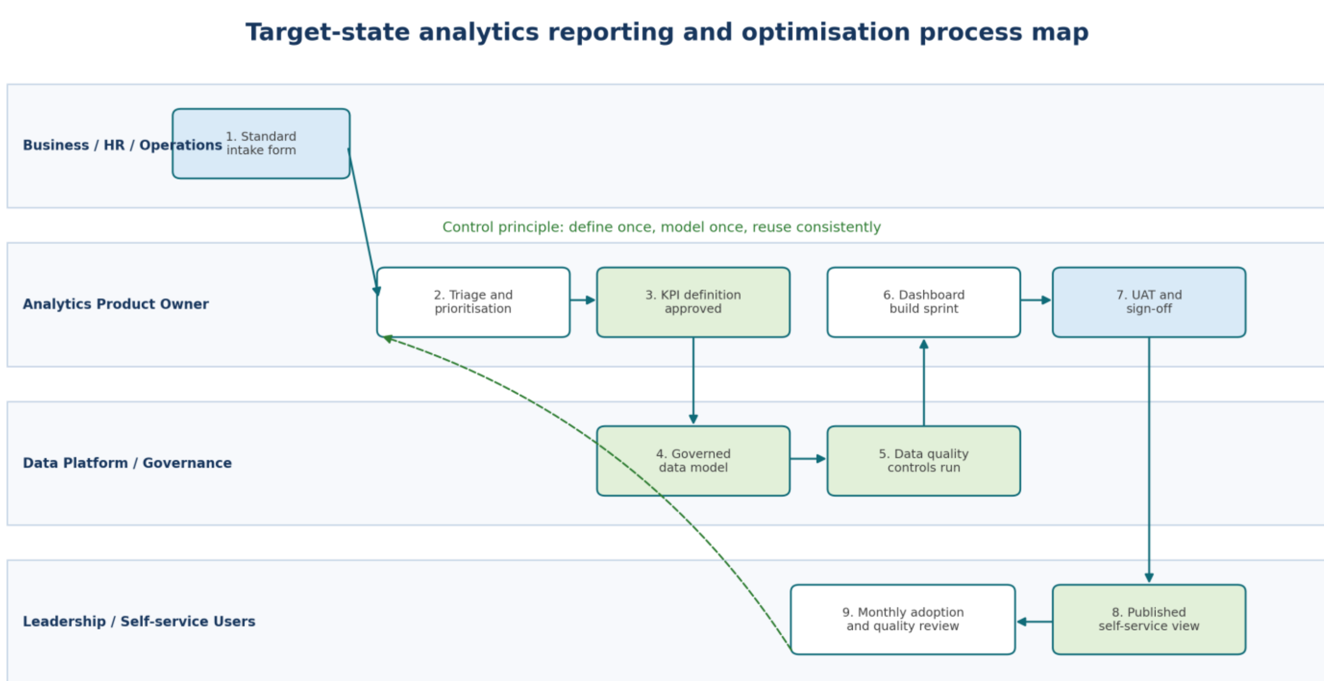

Figure 3. Target-state analytics reporting and optimisation process map.

6.1 Design principles

Principle	What it means	Practical control
Define once	Critical KPIs should not be redefined report by report.	Single KPI dictionary with named owner and calculation logic.
Model once	Repeat business rules should sit in governed datasets, not local copies.	Certified Power BI semantic model and documented transformations.
Validate early	Quality issues should be found before dashboard build or leadership review.	Data quality rules at extract, model and report levels.
Publish with ownership	Every report should have a clear product owner and support route.	Report catalogue with owner, purpose, refresh and access.
Retire duplicates	Old outputs should be removed when new certified reports replace them.	Quarterly report inventory review and retirement decision.
Improve continuously	Process defects should feed the improvement backlog.	Monthly quality, adoption and backlog review.

6.2 Target process control points

Control point	Purpose	Evidence captured	Exit criteria
C1. Intake triage	Confirm value, urgency, scope and owner.	Request form, priority score and acceptance criteria.	Request accepted, deferred or redirected.
C2. KPI definition	Confirm metric logic before build.	KPI dictionary entry and business owner approval.	Definition approved or gap logged.
C3. Source mapping	Confirm source, filters, joins and refresh needs.	Source-to-target mapping and lineage note.	Data owner accepts mapping.
C4. Quality rules	Detect defects before report build.	Completeness, validity, duplicate and reconciliation checks.	Exceptions resolved or documented.
C5. Prototype review	Validate the user journey and interpretation.	Prototype feedback and decisions.	Design direction accepted.
C6. UAT	Confirm numbers, access and usability.	UAT checklist and sign-off.	Ready to publish.
C7. Benefits review	Check adoption and process impact.	Usage data, defect log, rework log and feedback.	Continue, improve or retire.

7. Data lineage and ownership model

The lineage model provides a practical view of how analytics outputs should be controlled from source to decision. It separates source system responsibility, data preparation responsibility, KPI logic ownership, report publishing and business action ownership.

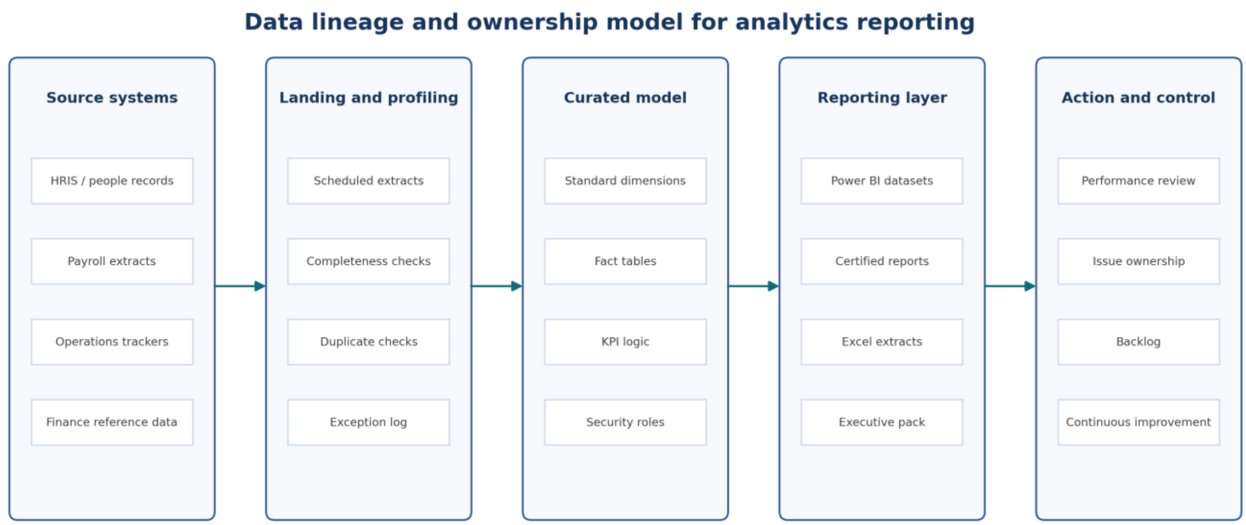

Figure 4. Data lineage and ownership model for analytics reporting.

7.1 Ownership model

Layer	Primary owner	Responsibilities	Typical evidence	Escalation route
Source system	Business system owner	Maintain source process, master data and operational accuracy.	Source field definition, extraction schedule, known issue log.	Functional lead / IT service owner.
Data extract	Data / analytics owner	Profile, extract and reconcile data into reporting layer.	Extract control totals, refresh log, exception log.	Analytics lead / data platform support.
Semantic model	Analytics product owner	Apply agreed business rules, relationships and reusable measures.	Model documentation, DAX/SQL logic, version notes.	Reporting governance forum.
KPI definition	Business metric owner	Approve definition, population, exclusions and interpretation.	KPI dictionary entry and sign-off record.	Senior business owner.
Report output	Analytics product owner and report consumer	Publish, consume, challenge and improve the output.	UAT record, report catalogue, usage metrics.	Monthly performance review.

8. Optimisation workstreams

The optimisation programme was broken into manageable workstreams so that improvement could happen in parallel without waiting for a full platform redesign. Each workstream had a clear outcome, delivery artefact and measurable success indicator.

Workstream	Objective	Key deliverables	Success measure	Priority
WS1. Intake and prioritisation	Standardise how analytics work enters the team.	Request form, triage criteria, prioritisation matrix, backlog board.	80 percent of new work enters via standard route.	High
WS2. KPI dictionary	Remove conflicting metric definitions.	KPI glossary, owner list, calculation logic and certification status.	Critical KPIs have an approved owner and definition.	High
WS3. Data quality controls	Detect recurring defects earlier.	Quality rule catalogue, exception log, DQ dashboard and root cause review.	Repeat defects reduce month on month.	High

WS4. Semantic model optimisation	Reduce duplicated report logic.	Standard dimensions, reusable measures, controlled relationships and documentation.	Manual transformations reduce across priority reports.	High
WS5. Dashboard lifecycle	Improve design, UAT and publishing discipline.	Report catalogue, UAT checklist, change log, retirement list.	Certified reports have documented purpose, owner and refresh.	Medium
WS6. Adoption and training	Increase user confidence and self-service usage.	Training packs, user guides, office hours and feedback loop.	Usage increases and manual pack requests reduce.	Medium

8.1 Prioritisation scoring

Backlog items were scored using a simple impact-versus-effort model. Items with high business impact, high risk reduction and low-to-medium implementation effort were prioritised first. This avoided spending time on cosmetic dashboard changes before fixing data confidence and definition issues.

Score factor	1 - Low	3 - Medium	5 - High	Weighting
Business impact	Nice-to-have insight	Supports team-level decision	Supports senior decision or contractual performance	30 percent
Risk reduction	Low reporting risk	Known inconsistency	High confidence, compliance or leadership risk	25 percent
Manual effort removed	Less than 1 hour per cycle	1 to 4 hours per cycle	More than 4 hours per cycle	20 percent
Reuse potential	Single report	Several reports	Reusable model or standard across domains	15 percent
Implementation effort	High effort	Medium effort	Low effort	10 percent, reversed

9. Implementation roadmap

The roadmap below shows a practical 12-week delivery plan. It assumes that process mapping, KPI governance, data quality and Power BI optimisation are delivered iteratively, with visible outputs created from the first few weeks rather than waiting for a single large release.

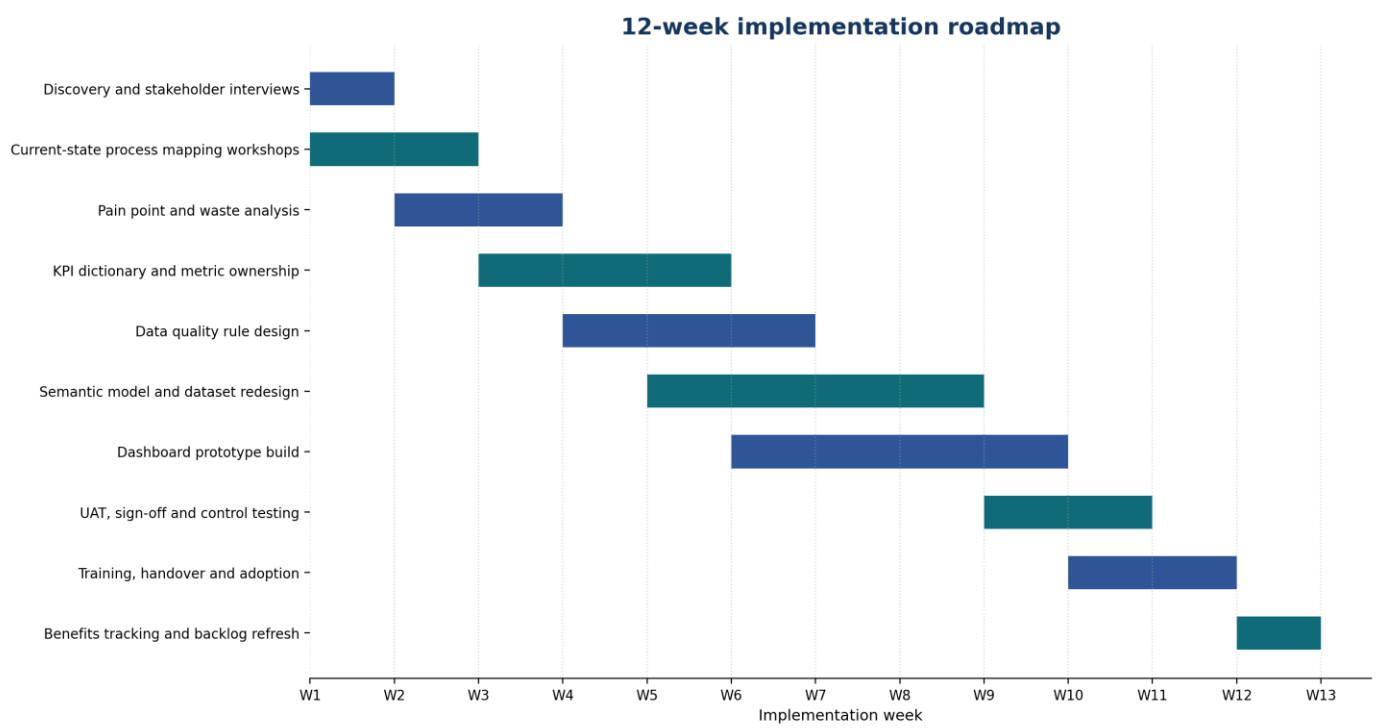

Figure 5. 12-week implementation roadmap.

9.1 Phase plan

Phase	Weeks	Focus	Key outputs	Gate / acceptance criteria
Phase 1 - Discover and map	1 to 3	Stakeholder interviews, report inventory, current process map and pain point log.	As-is map, SIPOC, initial RAID, current reporting inventory.	Stakeholders agree process map reflects reality.
Phase 2 - Design controls	3 to 6	KPI dictionary, data quality rules, RACI and target-state process.	KPI glossary, control checklist, target process, RACI.	Critical KPI owners and control points confirmed.
Phase 3 - Build and validate	5 to 10	Semantic model improvements, prototype dashboards, quality tests and UAT.	Certified dataset, dashboard prototype, UAT evidence, exception log.	Numbers reconciled and user journey accepted.
Phase 4 - Embed and improve	10 to 12	Training, handover, adoption tracking, benefits review and backlog refresh.	Training pack, report catalogue, adoption dashboard, benefits log.	Operational owner accepts handover and review cadence.

10. RACI and governance cadence

The RACI is designed to remove ambiguity. It shows who requests the work, who defines the metric, who owns source data, who builds the report and who signs off business interpretation. This is particularly important in analytics because many defects are ownership defects before they become technical defects.

Activity	Business owner	Analytics lead	BI developer	Data owner	IT / platform	Leadership consumer
Submit analytics request	A/R	C	I	I	I	I
Triage and prioritise backlog	C	A/R	C	C	I	C
Approve KPI definition	A/R	C	C	C	I	C
Map source fields and business rules	C	A	R	R	C	I
Build semantic model and measures	I	A	R	C	C	I
Run data quality checks	C	A/R	R	R	C	I
Build dashboard/report	C	A	R	C	I	C
Complete UAT and sign-off	A/R	C	R	C	I	C
Publish and manage access	I	A	R	I	R	I
Review adoption and benefits	C	A/R	C	C	I	A/C

Legend: R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed. Where A/R appears together, the same role owns both delivery and accountability for that activity.

10.1 Governance cadence

Meeting / control	Frequency	Attendees	Purpose	Output
Analytics triage	Weekly	Analytics lead, BI developer, business requestors as needed.	Review new demand, priorities, blockers and capacity.	Updated backlog and delivery priorities.

KPI governance review	Fortnightly during build, then monthly	Business owners, analytics, data owners.	Approve new KPI definitions and resolve conflicting logic.	Approved KPI dictionary changes.
Data quality review	Weekly during stabilisation, then monthly	Analytics, data owners, platform support.	Review exceptions, repeat defects and source issues.	DQ actions, owners and due dates.
Dashboard UAT checkpoint	Per release	Report owner, requestor, analytics, selected users.	Confirm usability, numbers and interpretation.	Signed UAT checklist.
Senior performance review	Monthly	Leadership consumers, analytics lead and domain owners.	Use reporting to agree actions and decisions.	Action log and performance commentary.
Continuous improvement review	Monthly / quarterly	Analytics lead, business owners and reporting consumers.	Review adoption, report inventory and improvement backlog.	Refreshed backlog and retired reports.

11. KPI dictionary and controls

A KPI dictionary is one of the most important artefacts in the framework. It prevents reporting disputes by capturing the agreed definition before dashboard build. It also makes handover easier because analysts, stakeholders and future report owners can see exactly how a metric is calculated.

KPI	Definition	Business owner	Formula / logic	Refresh	Control check	Status
Workforce headcount	Active employees in scope at reporting date.	HR operations	Count distinct employee ID where status = active and in reporting population.	Daily / monthly snapshot	Reconcile to HRIS active population.	Certified
Joiners	Employees with start date inside reporting period.	HR operations	Count distinct employee ID where start date between period start and end.	Monthly	Check against onboarding records.	Certified
Leavers	Employees with leaving date inside reporting period.	HR operations	Count distinct employee ID where leaving date between period start and end.	Monthly	Reconcile leaver report to HRIS.	Certified
Absence rate	Absence days as a percentage of available working days.	People analytics	Absence days / available working days x 100.	Weekly / monthly	Validate missing absence reason and date overlaps.	In review
Case volume	Number of cases opened in period.	Service operations	Count case ID by opened date and case type.	Daily / weekly	Check duplicate case IDs and invalid dates.	Certified
SLA achievement	Share of cases completed within agreed service standard.	Service operations	Completed within SLA / total completed cases x 100.	Weekly / monthly	Validate open/closed dates and SLA rule.	In review
Reporting adoption	Active users consuming certified analytics outputs.	Analytics lead	Unique users by report and period from usage data.	Monthly	Compare usage to target audience list.	Working metric

11.1 Data quality rule catalogue

Rule type	Example rule	Where checked	Failure action	Owner
Completeness	Mandatory fields such as employee ID, start date, cost centre or case ID must not be blank.	Extract and model layers	Log exception and route to data owner.	Data owner
Validity	Date fields must be valid and within expected business range.	Extract layer	Exclude from certified output until corrected or flagged.	Analytics / data owner

Uniqueness	Employee ID, case ID or other primary keys should not duplicate unexpectedly.	Model layer	Investigate duplicate source record or join issue.	Analytics lead
Referential integrity	Every fact record should map to a valid dimension such as team, location or cost centre.	Model layer	Create unmapped exception report.	Analytics / data owner
Timeliness	Refresh must complete by agreed reporting cut-off.	Refresh layer	Notify owner and record refresh incident.	Analytics / IT
Reconciliation	Critical totals should match agreed control totals or prior signed-off outputs.	Report layer	Hold publication or publish with caveat if agreed.	Analytics lead / business owner
Reasonableness	Movement outside threshold should be flagged for explanation.	Report layer	Add commentary or route to issue log.	Business owner

12. RAID and dependency management

RAID management was included because process optimisation usually fails when risks and dependencies are discussed informally but not tracked. The framework keeps RAID practical and linked to delivery decisions.

ID	Type	Description	Impact	Owner	Mitigation / action	Status
R1	Risk	Metric owners are unavailable to approve KPI definitions.	Build starts without agreed logic.	Analytics lead	Schedule KPI clinics and escalate overdue approvals.	Open
R2	Risk	Source data quality issues are not resolved in time.	Report confidence reduced.	Data owner	Use exception reporting and agreed publication caveats.	Open
A1	Assumption	Critical reports can be prioritised over cosmetic requests.	Roadmap remains deliverable.	Business sponsor	Confirm priorities in weekly triage.	Accepted
I1	Issue	Duplicate reports exist for similar workforce metrics.	Conflicting figures in circulation.	Analytics lead	Inventory reports and agree retirement path.	In progress
D1	Dependency	IT access and refresh permissions required for certified dataset.	Dataset build may be delayed.	IT / platform	Raise access request early and track SLA.	Open
D2	Dependency	Business users required for UAT during release window.	Sign-off may slip.	Business owner	Book UAT slots at start of sprint.	Open
Dec1	Decision	Only certified reports should be used for leadership reporting.	Improves consistency.	Leadership sponsor	Communicate report catalogue and retire duplicates.	Proposed

13. Benefits realisation

Benefits tracking was designed around operational evidence rather than broad claims. The key measures are cycle time, rework, data quality defects, report usage, duplicated reporting and stakeholder confidence. Each benefit should be linked to a baseline, an owner and a review cadence.

Benefit area	Baseline evidence	Target outcome	Measure	Review frequency	Owner
Cycle time	Request-to-publication duration varies by request type.	Reduced turnaround for repeat reporting.	Average working days from accepted request to release.	Monthly	Analytics lead
Manual effort	Repeated cleansing and manual packs.	Lower effort per reporting cycle.	Hours spent on manual extraction, cleansing and pack production.	Monthly	Analytics lead
Rework	Late changes caused by definition mismatch or data issue.	Fewer rework loops.	Number of rework items per release.	Per sprint / monthly	BI developer

Data quality	Issues found during review or after publication.	Earlier defect detection.	Open defects, repeat defects and exception ageing.	Weekly / monthly	Data owner
Reporting consistency	Multiple versions of similar metrics.	Single certified source for priority KPIs.	Number of certified KPIs and retired duplicate reports.	Monthly	Analytics lead
Adoption	Users request manual extracts instead of using dashboards.	Higher self-service usage.	Active users, repeat users and manual extract requests.	Monthly	Report owner
Decision quality	Leadership questions figures during review.	Higher confidence in insight and commentary.	Stakeholder feedback and meeting actions linked to report.	Quarterly	Business owner

13.1 Benefits dashboard design

- Process KPIs: average cycle time, backlog volume, ageing, blocked requests and sprint throughput.
- Quality KPIs: data defects, repeat defects, unresolved exceptions, reconciliation failures and refresh issues.
- Adoption KPIs: active users, usage by report, manual extract requests, training attendance and feedback rating.
- Governance KPIs: certified KPI count, overdue KPI approvals, report retirement count and UAT completion rate.
- Outcome KPIs: stakeholder confidence, leadership actions, reduced rework and improved management commentary quality.

14. Adoption, training and handover

A process improvement is only successful if users adopt the new way of working. The adoption plan therefore focused on making the framework easy to follow, not creating extra bureaucracy. Training materials were written around real reporting scenarios and common user questions.

Audience	Need	Training / enablement	Success indicator	Cadence
Business requestors	Know how to submit a clear analytics request.	Short intake guide and examples of good requirements.	Higher first-time acceptance rate.	Launch and refresh quarterly.
Metric owners	Understand responsibility for KPI definitions.	KPI dictionary walkthrough and owner checklist.	Fewer definition disputes.	Monthly KPI review.
Report consumers	Use certified dashboards confidently.	Power BI user guide, drop-in sessions and FAQs.	Increase in active users.	Office hours during launch, then monthly.
Analytics team	Apply consistent build, UAT and documentation standards.	Internal playbook and checklist templates.	Lower rework and cleaner handover.	Team ceremony per sprint.
Leadership users	Understand what changed and which reports to use.	Executive briefing and report catalogue.	Reduced use of duplicate packs.	Monthly review.

14.1 Handover pack

- Process maps: current state, target state and decision gates.
- KPI dictionary: definitions, owners, formulas, filters, refresh and certification status.
- Data lineage: source systems, transformation logic, refresh schedule and data quality checks.
- Report catalogue: purpose, audience, owner, access route, refresh and retirement status.
- UAT evidence: test cases, sign-off, known issues and release notes.
- Operational playbook: triage process, governance cadence, RAID management and escalation route.
- Training materials: user guides, quick reference cards and FAQ.

15. Continuous improvement backlog

The backlog turns process findings into action. Each item should have a clear owner, value case and status. The backlog below is structured as a working example for analytics and reporting improvement.

ID	Backlog item	Value	Effort	Priority	Owner	Next action
B1	Create standard analytics request form	High	Low	P1	Analytics lead	Draft and test with two business requestors.

B2	Build KPI dictionary for priority workforce and operations metrics	High	Medium	P1	Analytics lead / business owners	Run KPI definition workshop.
B3	Document source-to-target mapping for certified reports	High	Medium	P1	BI developer	Start with highest usage dashboards.
B4	Create data quality exception dashboard	High	Medium	P1	Analytics / data owner	Agree rule catalogue and exception thresholds.
B5	Introduce UAT checklist for dashboard releases	Medium	Low	P2	BI developer	Pilot on next dashboard change.
B6	Create report catalogue and certification status	High	Low	P1	Analytics lead	Inventory all recurring reports.
B7	Retire duplicate monthly packs	Medium	Medium	P2	Business owner	Compare usage and agree replacement reports.
B8	Run Power BI self-service training sessions	Medium	Low	P2	Analytics lead	Prepare user guide and office-hours plan.

Appendix A - SIPOC view

Suppliers	Inputs	Process	Outputs	Customers
HR operations, service operations, finance partners, IT, business leaders.	Source extracts, business rules, KPI definitions, reporting requirements, control totals.	Intake, triage, define, map data, build model, validate, publish, review.	Certified dashboards, management packs, KPI dictionary, exception logs, decision commentary.	Senior leaders, HR, operations, finance-adjacent teams, service managers.
Business system owners.	Source field definitions, refresh schedules, known issues.	Source mapping and data profiling.	Lineage notes, DQ rules, exception reports.	Analytics team and report consumers.
Analytics team.	Backlog, report inventory, user feedback, usage data.	Prioritise, build, UAT, release and support.	Release notes, report catalogue, training materials.	Requestors and self-service users.
Leadership consumers.	Business priorities, decision questions and action logs.	Performance review and benefit tracking.	Improvement backlog and decision records.	Analytics governance forum.
Data governance / platform support.	Access permissions, security roles, refresh failures and platform constraints.	Access control, publishing and support.	Secure certified datasets and refresh status.	Report owners and users.

Appendix B - Workshop agenda template

Time	Topic	Facilitation question	Output
10 min	Context and objective	What decision or process are we trying to improve?	Confirmed workshop scope.
20 min	Current-state walkthrough	What happens from request to final reporting output?	Draft process steps and handoffs.
20 min	Pain points	Where do delays, errors, rework or confusion happen?	Pain point and waste log.
20 min	Data and metric definition	Which fields, filters and calculations cause debate?	Definition gaps and data risks.
15 min	Ownership	Who should own the metric, data source, report and action?	Draft RACI.

20 min	Target-state design	What should the process look like when controlled properly?	To-be process changes.
15 min	Actions and next steps	What can be fixed immediately and what needs governance?	Action log and backlog items.

Appendix C - Standard analytics request template

Section	Question	Expected response
Business need	What decision, action or process will this insight support?	Clear description of business value.
Audience	Who will use the report and at what level?	Named team, role or leadership group.
Required metrics	Which KPIs or measures are needed?	Metric names and known definitions.
Population	Which employees, cases, services, teams or periods are in scope?	Inclusion and exclusion rules.
Time period	What date range and refresh frequency are required?	Start/end period and refresh cadence.
Source data	Which systems or files currently hold the data?	Source name and owner if known.
Decision timing	When is the output required and why?	Deadline and business consequence.
Format	Is the need dashboard, dataset, Excel export, management pack or analysis?	Preferred output type.
Security	Is there sensitive, restricted or role-based access?	Access constraints and approval route.
Success criteria	How will we know this has worked?	Adoption, decision, quality or time-saving measure.
Owner	Who can sign off definitions and output?	Business owner and backup contact.

Appendix D - Definition of done for certified reporting

- Business question and audience are documented.
- KPI definitions are captured and approved by named owners.
- Source-to-target mapping is documented for critical fields.
- Data quality checks are run and exceptions are resolved or recorded.
- Dashboard or report passes UAT with evidence retained.
- Security and access have been reviewed.
- Report is added to the catalogue with owner, refresh cadence and support route.
- Release notes, known issues and training material are available.
- Duplicate or superseded outputs are identified for retirement.
- Benefits and adoption measures are added to the monthly review.

Closing note

This framework is intended to be practical and repeatable. Its value comes from making analytics delivery visible: who asks for insight, who defines the metric, who owns the data, who builds the model, who validates the output and who acts on the result. By standardising those points, the reporting process becomes easier to govern, easier to audit and easier for users to trust.